



IIT ROORKEE



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CERTIFICATION COURSE

# Public Speaking

## Lecture 40: Preparing for Interview

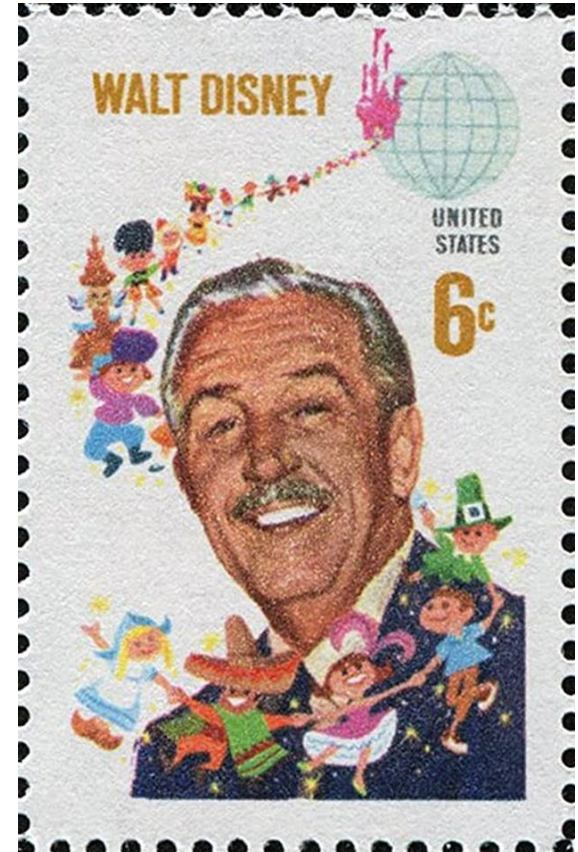
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*All our dreams can come true, if we have the courage to pursue them.*

- Walt Disney



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# Introduction

- Interviews are a space for showcasing your qualifications, ability and skills.
- The idea is “to sell yourself” in the job market.
- The candidate is both the product and the seller.
- The candidate should express sound knowledge of his capabilities and the company’s need where s/he is applying for a vacant position.



# Step-by-Step Preparation for Interview

Job description analysis

Eligibility check

Research about the company

Anticipate the expected interview questions

Revise your subject knowledge

Develop interview file

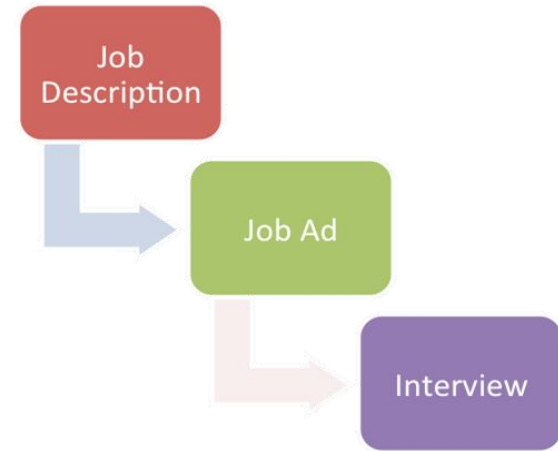
# Approaching the Interview



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# Job description analysis

- Search for talking points in the job description.
- Make notes on those key points relevant to your achievements and experiences.
- Pick out stories from the past that will support you to impress the selection team.



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# Self-assessment before Interview

Self-assessment before the interview helps the candidate to become aware of their:

- Strengths
- Weaknesses
- Eligibilities
- Goals
- Interests

Through such self-assessment, one can choose to highlight their pros and downplay their cons during the interview process.

# Self-assessment Questionnaire

Answering these questions shall help an individual to introspect themselves and handle the same questions efficiently when asked during the interview.

## Strengths

- What are your greatest strengths? Why do you consider them so?

## Weakness

- What are your weaknesses? How do you plan to overcome them?

## Eligibility

- How do you think that you are the right fit for this job?

## Goals

- Where do you want to be in five year?
- What are your short term/ long term goals?

## Interests

- What courses did you enjoy learning?
- Tell me about the project which helped you grow in this field?

# Background research about the Company

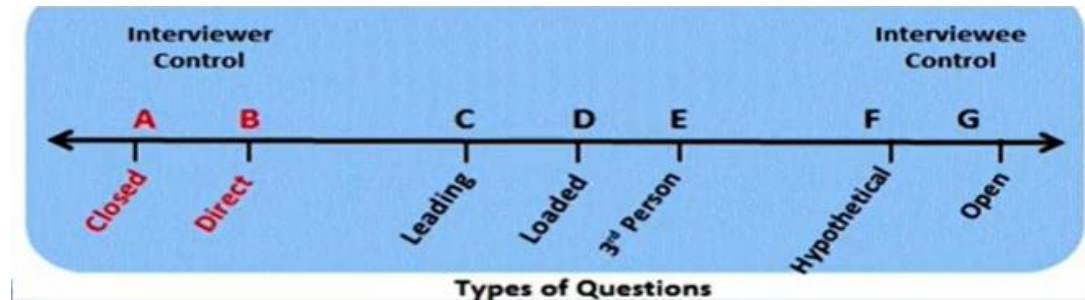
1. Refer to the company/organisation's website to learn about its mission, vision, core values, services and projects.
2. Check the news section about the company's recent developments and milestones.
3. These steps shall help you express your interests in their company and build a rapport with them through conversation.
4. Make sure you know the fundamentals about the company's location, market value, reputation, current projects, culture etc.



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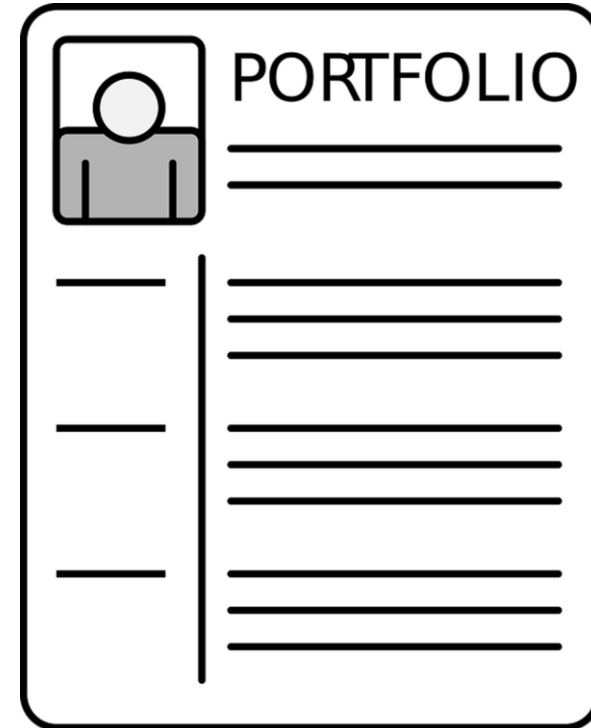
# Types of Questions Expected

1. Open questions
2. Closed questions
3. Probing questions
4. Reflective questions
5. Loaded questions
6. Hypothetical questions
7. Leading questions



# Developing Interview File

- A solid coloured (black/ brown) leather file with an ample number of holders is suggested.
- Make sure that the *resume* is placed first for easy reference.
- Curate your certificate (educational, professional and extracurricular) for verification purposes.
- Letter of recommendation (LoR) usually comes in handy for job interviews.
- Always have a copy of original documents in case of emergency.

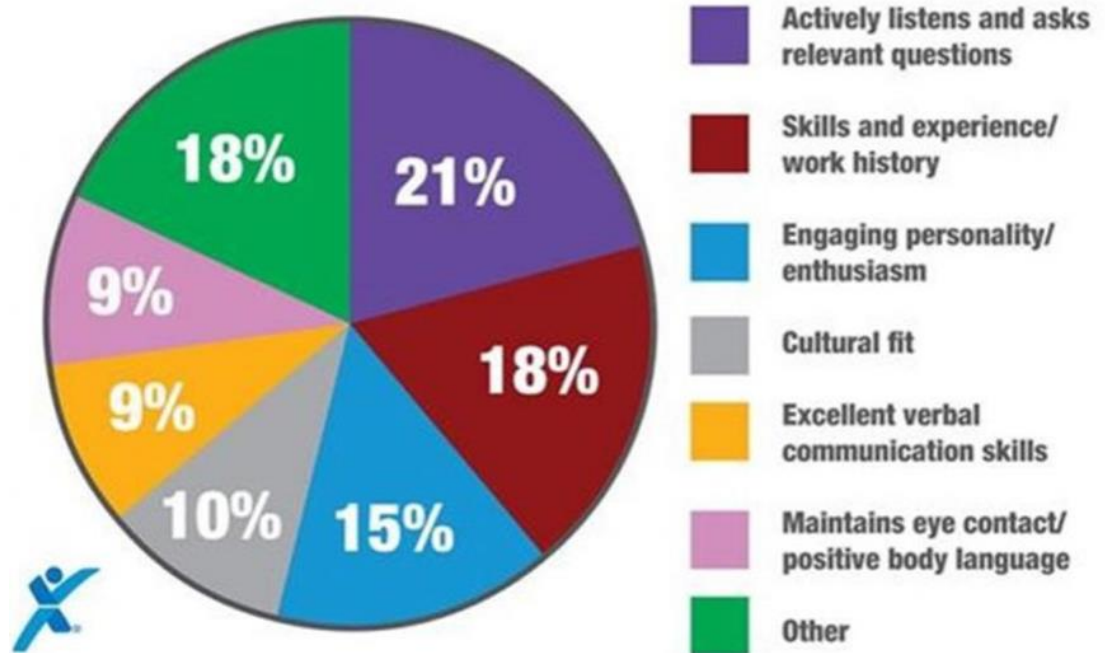


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# What most improves a candidate's chances during the job interview?

## Qualities for Acing Interview

**Source:** A survey of 2,169 business leaders and decision-makers was conducted through the Express Refresh Leadership organization.



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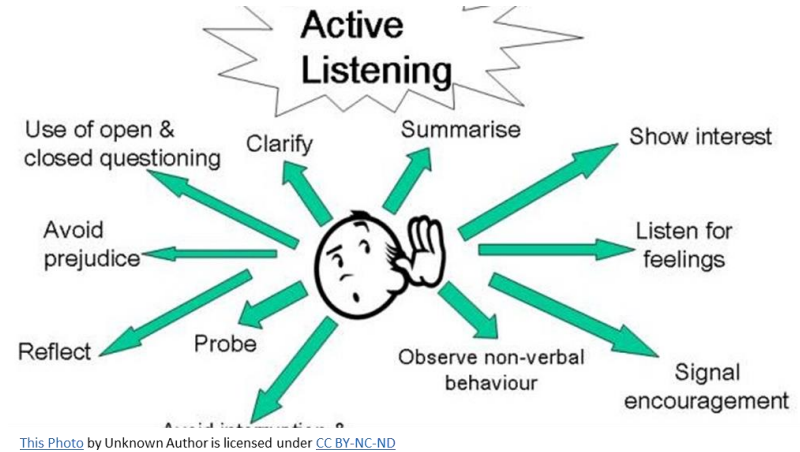
# Controlling the Nerves

- ❖ Nervousness is natural, yet it can fail if not controlled.
- ❖ One can use the Row Boat Technique to control nervousness.
- ❖ Contraction of the abdomen in combination with rhythmic breathing
- ❑ Row Boat Technique
  - ✓ Sit forward in a chair, arms outstretched, imagining you are grabbing oars in a rowboat
  - ✓ Take a deep breath, then slowly pull back your arms and contract the abdominal muscle just below the rib cage.
  - ✓ As you exhale air, roll the contraction of the muscle downward, above your pelvic region, centring on your navel.
  - ✓ Keep your muscles tight until all of the air is released.
  - ✓ Count to three (don't breathe in yet!), then inhale deeply.



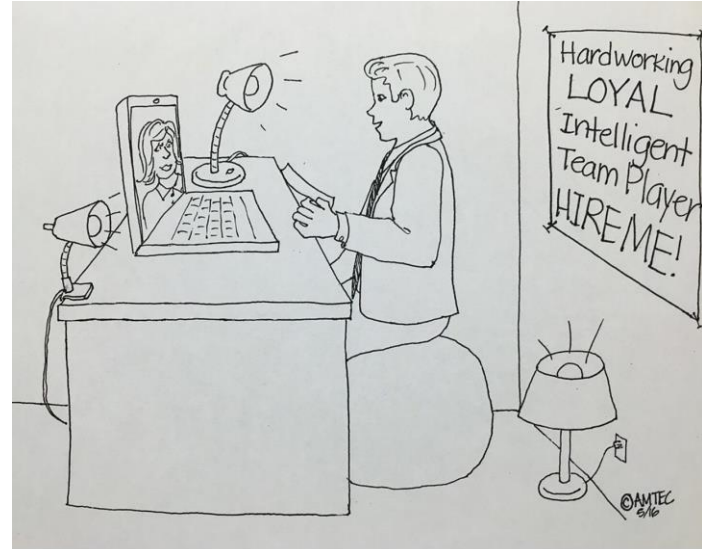
# Active Listening and Effective Questioning

- Interview is two-way communication.
- It is a dialogue between the interviewer and the interviewee.
- Thus, it becomes imperative to listen and reflect for engaging in an effective conversation.
- Employ 'inquisitive listening and strategic listening.'
- Active listening helps to reflect with practical questions through which one can impress the interviewer.



# Acquired Skills for Interview

- ❖ Interpersonal skills
  - ❖ Communication
  - ❖ Team work
  - ❖ Problem-solving
- ❖ Negotiation Skills
- ❖ Formal Writing Skills
- ❖ Vocational Training
- ❖ Computer Programming
- ❖ Other Technical Skills



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# Things to do a day before interview

- ✓ Do thorough research about the organisation and also the position.
- ✓ Plan to sell yourself both verbally and non-verbally.
- ✓ Arrange the formal dress for the occasion of the interview. Well pressed, neat and clean.
- ✓ Ensure to wear formal leather shoes, making them well-polished.
- ✓ Keep your interview file close and safe, along with the call letter for the interview.
- ✓ Arrive early and familiarise yourself with the interview centre.
- ✓ Anticipate questions and their answers.



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# Interviewers' Expectations

- ❖ I- Intelligence
- ❖ N- Negotiation
- ❖ T- Timeliness
- ❖ E- Enthusiasm
- ❖ R- Reasoning
- ❖ V- Versatility
- ❖ I- Innovation
- ❖ E- Earnestness
- ❖ W- Well-rounded



Personality  
Communication Skills  
Self-confidence  
Objective  
Competence  
General Awareness  
Intelligence  
Consistency

# Works Consulted

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“It does not matter how slowly you go as long as you don’t stop.”

— Confucius

**Thank You**

